uniform, generally returning home from Warmbaths Primary School, nipping into his room, borrowing one of his Affies jerseys and wearing it for the rest of the day.

On one occasion, feeling brave, I nipped into his room at the start of the day and turned up at my primary school wearing the Affies jersey – grey with the famous red, green and yellow trim.

Our primary school headmaster was not pleased.

'De Villiers, you need to take that off,' he told me.

'Why?'

'It's the uniform of another school.'

'I'm wearing this jersey because it is so cold today,' I protested gamely.

'Take it off now.'

'Please, sir.'

'Now.'

The years could not pass quickly enough and, in January 1998, I duly arrived at Afrikaanse Hoër Seunskool as an excited new boy, and obediently wrote out the school's Honour Code 100 times. I missed my parents and home back in Warmbaths, but few boys could have been so eager to start boarding school.

For me, it was the start of a special time in my life ... take the N1 south towards Pretoria, turn off the highway at the Lynnwood Road off-ramp, head towards the city, past Menlo Park High School on your left, past the University of Pretoria hostels on your right, on until the soaring floodlights of Loftus Versfeld rise ahead of you. Then, at the roundabout, with the Pretoria East NG church ahead, look to your left and see the school gates, and note the school crest attached to the central post and read the visible motto ... '*Laat daar lig wees*' (Let there be light).

Welcome to Affies.

Our sister school, the Afrikaanse Hoër Meisieskool, stood beyond the church, and if you followed Jorissen Street round to the left past our A field, turned left on Walton Jameson Avenue and headed up the hill, you